

Formatting Checklist for Research Assignments, Theses & Dissertations: 2025_2026

Description	Check box Student	Check box Supervisor	Supervisor Remarks to Student
Cover Page The SU cover page template with Cambria / Calibri fonts has to be used and the font may not be changed to anything else Top third of page Title			
Cover Page: Below Title Author's full names and surname below title			
Cover page: In the middle below the author's name & surname (check layout & spacing for cover page) Dissertation presented for the degree of Doctor of Philosophy in the Faculty of Engineering at Stellenbosch University / Dissertation presented for the degree of Doctor of Philosophy in Biomedical Engineering in the Faculty of Engineering at Stellenbosch University Thesis presented in partial fulfilment of the requirements for the degree of Master of Engineering (Mechanical Engineering / Mechatronic Engineering) in the Faculty of Engineering at Stellenbosch University Thesis presented in partial fulfilment of the requirements for the degree of Master of Engineering Science (Biomedical Engineering) in the Faculty of Engineering at Stellenbosch University Research Assignment presented in partial fulfilment of the requirements for the degree of Master of Engineering (Mechanical Engineering) in the Faculty of Engineering at Stellenbosch University If the thesis/dissertation forms part of a joint- or double-degree agreement with another university, the following sentence must be added: "This thesis/dissertation has also been presented at (state the name of the other university here) in terms of a joint-/double-degree agreement." If the student concerned received a study bursary from the National Research Foundation (NRF) , the NRF requires that the following wording appear on the title page (just below the above formula): "The financial assistance of the National Research Foundation (NRF) towards this research is hereby acknowledged. Opinions expressed and conclusions arrived at, are those of the author and are not necessarily to be attributed to the NRF."			
Cover Page: At the bottom The name/s of the supervisor/co-supervisor/s and the year and month in which the degree will be awarded e.g. December 2025 OR March 2026			
Page i: Upper half DECLARATION By submitting this research assignment/thesis/dissertation (<i>choose the correct option</i>) electronically, I declare that the entirety of the work contained therein is my own, original work, that I am the sole author thereof (save to the extent explicitly otherwise stated), that reproduction and publication thereof by Stellenbosch University will not infringe any third party rights and that I have not previously in its entirety or in part submitted it for obtaining any qualification. Date:..... (<i>month & year of graduation</i>) <i>In case of a paper-based dissertation, the following general declaration should be added as a 2nd paragraph :</i> This dissertation includes [insert number] original papers published in peer reviewed journals or books and [insert number] unpublished publications. The development and writing of the papers (published and unpublished) were the principal responsibility of myself and, for each of the cases where this is not the case, a declaration is included in the dissertation indicating the nature and extent of the contributions of co-authors."			
Page i: Lower half Copyright ©2025 Stellenbosch University / Copyright ©2026 Stellenbosch University (<i>year of electronic submission [e-thesis] on SUNScholar</i>) All rights reserved			
Page ii: English abstract of not more than 500 words			
Page iii: Acknowledgements			
Page iv: Dedication			
Table of contents: All entries must have page numbers Appendices with title must be listed			
List of figures: All entries must have page numbers			
List of tables: All entries must have page numbers			

Nomenclature (alphabetical) - optional			
Abbreviations			
Roman symbols (symbol, word, typical units)			
Greek symbols (symbol, word, typical units)			
Subscripts			
<u>Dimensionless numbers</u>			
Headings before the Introduction are not numbered			
The Introduction must be Chapter 1			
Section numbering 1, 2 etc or 1.1, 1.2 etc			
First appendix must be Appendix A, with an appendix title (similar to a chapter title)			
Numbering A.1 etc			
Capitalisation of headings must be consistent			
A section cannot have only one sub-section			
Not more than a single paragraph before the first sub heading			
Page numbers:			
None on the title page			
Page numbers:			
Declaration is on page i			
Page numbers:			
Introduction is on page 1			
Page numbers:			
Appendices continue with page numbers of body or start on page A.1, B.1, etc			
Equation numbers			
Captions:			
Above for tables; on same page as table			
Captions:			
Below for figures, on same page as figure			
References:			
Alphabetical e.g. (Basson and Von Backström, 2007)			
Reference list must be alphabetical			
References:			
Numerical			
References must be numbered in the order of their first appearance			
Font type & Line spacing (LS):			
A4: Times new roman; 12 pts; single line spacing			
A4: Calibri (Body), Cambria (Headings): 12 pts, single line spacing			
A4: Arial; 11 pts; single line spacing			
Computer Modern & Charter also permitted according to the Technical Writing Guide			
Margins:			
Single-sided: Left/Right 35/35 mm			
Top/Bottom 26/44 mm			
Number and units must be separated by a hard space			
Symbols for physical quantities must be in <i>italics</i> ; units, cos, sin, ... must NOT be in italics			
Text of figures must not be smaller than 10 points			
Page limits:			
PhD: 200 pages from intro to end of the document (including references and appendices)			
MEng R: 80 (max 82p)/40 appendices			
MEngSc R: 100/40 appendices			
MEng S: 60/30 appendices			
MEngSc S: 60/30 appendices			
GRAMMAR: A few paragraphs in different chapters should be checked to confirm the writing style & grammar are acceptable - if not the student should have it professionally edited and provide proof of editing.			
End of Line Strategy to PG work - plans are included and discussed with the supervisor what to do with the project after completion.			

Student name, surname & Signature

Supervisor name, surname & Signature

Date:

Date:

This document should be used in conjunction with the following documents:

- * SU General Calendar (Part 1),
- * Engineering Calendar,
- * PG Study Guide &
- * Technical Writing Guide_2024 version